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TO DO LIST

*Places to go
and things to do*

Submit, and read, event listings @ dailycamera.com

If you want your event to appear here, please use <http://calendar.dailycamera.com> to submit your event. If you'd like to be considered for "Pick of the Day," please also submit a high-resolution photo (not a poster or a logo) to us by email at todo@dailycamera.com, including the name and date of the event in the subject line of the email.

LIBRARIES

CU at the Library: "Exercise & Stress Robustness: Benefits for Mental and Physical Health" | This program is presented by Monika Fleshner, Ph.D., professor of integrative physiology at the University of Colorado. Fleshner will present scientific evidence that regular physical activity promotes stress robustness and changes the way the brain and body respond to stressors, 7 p.m., Louisville Public Library, 951 Spruce St., Louisville, free; 303-335-4820.

The Real Deal Non-Fiction Book Club | A meet and greet of the first meeting. The book club will read and discuss the best non-fiction subjects such as history, adventure, biographies, economics, personal growth and more. Join us on the second Wednesday of each month; books are available at the Erie Community Library 30 days prior to the monthly meeting, 6:30 p.m., Erie Community Library, 400 Powers St., Erie, free; 720-685-5200.

FILM

The Power of Video Storytelling for Non-Profits | Nonprofits must

PICK OF THE DAY



Courtesy photo

Judith Orloff, speaking tonight at Red Door Studios.

Keeping resolutions

Radical Love Foundation Founder Judith Orloff will lead free class with open discussion: what would our lives be like if we were accountable for our resolutions' success? Discover how to keep your word and have a renewed beginning in 2013, 5:30-7 p.m., Red Door Studios, 4439 N Broadway, Unit A, Boulder, free; 303-415-0056.

Boulder Public Library Cosmology discussion group presents a Teaching Company video lecture series on "Dark Matter, Dark Energy" by Caltech Cosmologist

Firebreathers | 10 p.m., Pioneer Inn, 15 E. First St., Nederland, free; 303-258-7733.

John March, Chris Engleman and Jav

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UP CLOSE JUDITH ORLOFF

The deeper side of Valentine's Day

By Aimee Heckel
Camera Staff Writer

As a child, Judith Orloff never quite got "Cinderella."

She couldn't swallow the idea that there was a "good sister" and "bad sisters." They were all different, she remembers telling her mom at age 3. What was the story behind the stepsisters? Why did everyone call them "mean" without knowing their side of the story? Why did anyone have to label them anything to begin with?

You could say it was storytime at age 3 that sparked Orloff's lifelong passion.

The Boulder woman runs a nonprofit called the Radical Love Foundation. The mis-

sion is to teach others how to be authentic in all relationships using simple, practical ways. Simplified, she teaches people how to ask the right questions to tap into the existing internal wisdom that answers life's tough questions.

She teaches acceptance of what is, with no interpretations, explanations, rationalizations and manipulation.

"We welcome each person to have their own experience, including ones we don't agree with and don't like," the website explains.

Yes, even the ugly stepsisters.

Orloff is offering a public class on Wednesday, the day before Valentine's Day, called "What is Love? Being

in an Authentic Relationship."

During the event, scheduled for 5:30-7 p.m. at the Red Door Studios in Boulder, Orloff will share her ideas with the community.

"We will invite the community to come and learn about how to be in an authentic relationship without stress, how to see your partner as a unique world to explore, rather than someone to change," Orloff says. "How to see who they really are, and what they're really saying, and the love inside it — no matter what it sounds like. A glimpse into their true nature. And then share our true natures. And the conflict is dissolved, at least for that moment."



Jessica Cuneo | For the Camera

Judith Orloff teaches acceptance of what is, with no interpretations, explanations, rationalizations and manipulation.

She says the techniques can help any relationship — with your child, parents, business partner, lover.

We were curious to learn more specifically what she meant by "radical love," so we tapped her brain last week. Here's what she told us.

What are you trying to teach people to do?

To shift in the middle of a reactive state, in the middle of their history, when they are so angry, or so sure they are right about something, or blaming their parents with evidence. We created a

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Up Close: Judith Orloff teaches 'understanding'

Continued from 6

way for people to stop and see what was really going on, and from that place, their world shifted because they no longer had to blame anyone.

We teach people that all feelings are equal. Whether you're Cinderella or the evil stepsister.

What are some specific points you will talk about at your Valentine's Day event?

Learning to be with and abide in "what is," rather than wanting things to be different than they are. Not trying to change someone.

Dissolving reactive, patterned behaviors rather than dwelling on who is right and who is wrong.

Knowing that no matter what, we can't change anyone or change their experience, even on a romantic holiday.

So how might you use Radical Love in a lover's conflict.

I always cook as if I have a family of 10 people. And my husband is a do-not-waste, do-not-hurt-the-earth person. He would come home as I was cooking and make a face and just be angry. He didn't want to be angry at me, but he felt like I was doing something wrong. And I knew that, but I was hiding the leftovers and so unwilling to stop cooking that way — and I didn't even know why.

One day, he came home, and I was nervous because I knew what I had done. But he looked at me with such love and simply said, "Tell me why."

As I told him what was coming up at the moment, I realized I was trying to recreate a happy family with lots of people in it. I didn't

know the little kid inside me was so needy for that experience. When he asked me why, he became that family. He dealt with what was, rather than trying to change me. Then I was able to shift. I don't need to do that anymore. I cook for two now.

Why do you think this message is so relevant around Valentine's Day?

As a woman, I've been besieged with Hallmark and tortured with TV programs where men act a certain way — and that's not the way people are.

We have expectations from the media — what we're told we should have, the right way to be — and Valentine's Day brings that to a head for many people. They act as if it doesn't matter when it does, or as if it does matter when it doesn't.

I want to get to the inside of Valentine's Day, without

all of the fanfare, what really is true in love, what is important, what can Valentine's Day really bring you that celebrates your life, not anybody else's. Not a picture, but really what *is*.

So is this some kind of therapy then?

No, we allow people (to access their inner knowledge) without being pressured or feeling like a therapy session, without being probed or threatened; we follow their lead.

There are no techniques, no suggestions. They give their own suggestions. It's a little para-intuitive and it's direct.

Just like when my husband asked me why. He asked me a question from an open space, just from love and curiosity. And we teach people how to do that. It's simple. Anyone can do it.

You already have this

If you go

What: "What is Love? Being in an Authentic Relationship," with Judith Orloff

When: 5:30-7 p.m. Wednesday

Where: Red Door Studios, 4439 N. Broadway Unit A, Boulder

Cost: Donation

Info: <http://radicallovefoundation.org/>, 303-957-7126

knowing. It's already in you. It's in all humans.

And it's learning how to use "skillful means," an old Buddhist term. In every moment, there is a skillful way to deal with every moment — and it can't come from your history. It has to come from abiding what *is*, rather than trying to change anything.

Instead of correcting, explaining and justifying, what comes instead of that? A deep understanding.